Zero to Pro — Learning Plan

Simple step-by-step plan to prepare for your QA Intern interview and assignment

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This is a simple day-by-day plan. You don't need to be an expert in everything — just understand each topic well enough to explain it in your own words and apply it to your assignment.

Day 1 — Understand the Basics of QA (Testing)

Goal: Know what a QA person actually does, in simple words.

- Learn what 'testing an app' means — trying things to see if they work or break
- Learn the difference between manual testing (doing it yourself by clicking around) and automation testing (writing a script that does the clicking for you)
- Learn these 4 words: regression testing, smoke testing, sanity testing, exploratory testing — just know what each one means in one line
- Learn the difference between a 'test case' (a plan of what to check) and a 'bug report' (what you write when something is broken)

Tip: Simple way to remember: Test case = what to check. Bug report = what went wrong.

Day 2 — Learn How to Write a Bug Report

Goal: Be able to write a clear bug report, step by step.

- Learn the parts of a bug report: Title, Steps to reproduce, Expected result, Actual result, Screenshot, Severity, Priority
- Learn severity vs priority in simple terms: Severity = how badly it's broken. Priority = how soon it needs fixing
- Practice: pick any app on your phone, find one small issue, and write a full bug report for it

Tip: Use the earlier 'How to Write a Good Bug Report' PDF as your step-by-step reference.

Day 3 — Learn REST API Basics

Goal: Understand what an API is and how to test one, in simple terms.

- An API is just a way for two computer systems to talk to each other
- Learn these 5 words: GET (read data), POST (create data), PUT (update data), DELETE (remove data), PATCH (small update)
- Learn common status codes: 200 = success, 201 = created, 400 = bad request, 401 = not allowed, 404 = not found, 500 = server error
- Install Postman (a free tool) and try sending a GET request to any free public API

Tip: You don't need to be an expert coder — just understand what each request does and what the response means.

Day 4 — Learn Basic Automation Testing Concepts

Goal: Be able to talk about automation testing even if you haven't coded much.

- Automation testing = writing a script that clicks/tests things for you automatically, instead of doing it by hand every time
- Learn the names: Selenium, Playwright, Cypress — just know they are tools used for this
- Watch one beginner YouTube video on Selenium or Playwright — just to see what it looks like
- You don't need to master coding — just be able to explain what automation testing is and why it's useful

Day 5 — Learn What RL Environments and Graders Are

Goal: Understand what makes this role different from normal QA jobs.

- The company builds fake/simulated versions of office software (like a fake CRM or fake HR tool)
- This fake software is used to train AI models to do real work, like a practice ground
- A 'task' is an instruction given to the AI, like 'update this customer's phone number'
- A 'grader' is a checker that decides if the AI did the task correctly — pass or fail
- Your job is to make sure the task instructions are clear and the grader checks are correct

Tip: Simple way to remember: App = practice room. Task = the question. Grader = the answer key. You check all three.

Day 6 — Practice Thinking Like a Grader-Checker

Goal: Practice spotting problems in tasks and graders, since this is unique to your assignment/role.

- Pick any simple app (like a to-do list app) and write a task, e.g. 'Mark the grocery task as done'
- Write a simple pass/fail rule for that task (this is your practice 'grader')
- Now try to break your own rule: do the task slightly differently and see if your grader still works correctly
- Ask yourself: could this task be understood in more than one way? If yes, that's a real issue you'd flag in this job

Day 7 — Review Your Assignment + Practice Explaining It

Goal: Be fully ready to explain your submitted assignment out loud.

- Re-read every bug you found in your assignment
- For each bug, be ready to explain: what you found, how you found it, why it matters (severity/priority)
- Think about anything you might have missed — be honest about it if asked
- Practice saying your answers out loud, like a real interview, not just reading them

Quick Summary — 7 Day Plan at a Glance

Day	Focus
1	QA basics — what testing means
2	How to write a clear bug report
3	REST API basics
4	Automation testing concepts
5	RL environments and graders (role-specific)
6	Practice spotting task/grader problems
7	Review your assignment and practice explaining it

Golden rule: you don't need to know everything perfectly. You just need to understand each idea well enough to explain it simply, and show that you think carefully and notice details.